GUIDELINES AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

CEDA Innovation Management Portal

How to apply, how ideas are assessed and what to expect at each stage

Citizen Entrepreneurial Development Agency (CEDA), Botswana
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Finance. Develop. Sustain.

SAMPLE DOCUMENT. Prepared for the CEDA Innovation Management Portal Hackathon prototype. Figures, dates, eligibility rules and contact details are placeholders and must be replaced with CEDA's approved guidelines before any live use.

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1. About the portal

The CEDA Innovation Management Portal is where Botswana's innovators register their ideas for national review, funding and support. Every idea follows the same five stages, so you can see exactly where it stands at any time.

This document explains what to prepare, how ideas are assessed, and what happens after you submit. Read it before you start your application.

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Submission	**Review**	**Feedback**	**Approval**	**Award**
You register and send the idea	Assessed in levels by evaluators	Questions and requests to you	Adjudicator's recorded decision	Grant or support agreed

2. Who can apply

- **Individuals:** citizens of Botswana aged 18 or older, with a valid Omang (National Identity Card).
- **Businesses and groups:** citizen-owned entities registered with CIPA, or groups, cooperatives and joint ventures that are at least 100% citizen-owned as defined under the CEDA Act. A group application must list its team members.
- **Students and researchers:** may apply individually. Please confirm any specific call's age or sector rules before applying.

> **Note:** Eligibility rules can differ between open calls. The rules shown on each call take priority over this general guide.

3. How to apply

Before you start

- Have your Omang number, email address and mobile number ready. Your mobile number will be verified.
- For a business or group: the trading name, CIPA registration number and BURS tax identification number.
- Your supporting documents, saved as PDF, DOCX, JPG or PNG files of 10 MB or less each.

The four steps

STEP	WHAT YOU PROVIDE	MANDATORY
1. Applicant details	Identity, contact, district and town, and team members (for a group)	Yes
2. Idea details	Title, sector, problem, solution, what is new, beneficiaries, stage of development, location, funding requested, expected jobs, timeline and intellectual property status	Yes
3. Documents	Copy of Omang or passport; concept note; budget estimate. Optional: proof of residence, CIPA certificate, letters of support	Core documents
4. Review and submit	Check your details and confirm the declaration of citizenship and accuracy	Yes

Saving your progress: drafts are saved as you go. You can leave and return to a draft at any time. Only submitted ideas enter the review process.

4. Stages and timelines

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	TYPICAL TIMING
Submission	Your idea is received and given a reference number, for example CEDA-INN-2026-0001	Immediate
Review	Screening (Level 1), technical review (Level 2) and panel review (Level 3) by evaluators	About 14 days
Feedback	Evaluators may ask questions. You have a deadline to reply, usually 7 to 14 days	Set per request
Approval	An adjudicator records the final decision with a written justification	After review
Award	Funding or support is confirmed and the agreement is issued	Subject to funding

Timelines are targets for planning. They are not guarantees of a decision date.

5. Evaluation criteria and scoring

Each idea is scored by evaluators on six criteria. Each criterion is scored from 1 (very weak) to 10 (excellent). The weights below give a weighted total out of 100.

CRITERION	WHAT EVALUATORS LOOK FOR	WEIGHT
Innovation and originality	A clear new approach or product, and how it differs from what already exists in Botswana	**20%**
Feasibility	Whether the idea can be delivered: technical plan, timeline, resources and risks	**20%**
Market potential and impact	Demand, customers or beneficiaries, and the problem it solves for communities	**20%**
Job creation and economic impact	Number and quality of jobs, local value added and contribution to diversification	**15%**
Financial viability	Realistic budget, funding need, revenue or repayment model and value for money	**15%**
Team capability	Skills, experience and commitment of the applicant and team members	**10%**

How the weighted total is calculated

For each criterion, multiply the score (1 to 10) by its weight, then add them up. For example, a score of 8 on a 20% criterion contributes 16 points. The maximum total is 100.

> **Low scores need an explanation:** any criterion scored below 4 must have a written comment from the evaluator.

6. How ideas are assessed

Levels

- **Level 1 Screening:** checks completeness and eligibility. Personal details are hidden from evaluators (blind review).
- **Level 2 Technical review:** assesses feasibility and innovation by sector experts.
- **Level 3 Panel review:** a panel discusses scores and agrees a recommendation.

Fairness safeguards

- Evaluators declare any conflict of interest before scoring.
- Each evaluator scores independently before seeing others' scores.
- Large disagreements between evaluators are flagged for panel discussion.

7. Decisions and awards

After panel review, an adjudicator records one of the following decisions, with a written justification that you can see in your submission record:

- **Approve** or **Approve with conditions**
- **Return for more information**, with a deadline to respond
- **Decline**, with the reason
- **Award**, with the approved amount and any conditions

Decisions are recorded in the audit trail and cannot be edited afterwards. Funding is subject to CEDA's funding rules and to the signed agreement.

8. Feedback, resubmission and appeals

- When evaluators need more information, you receive a notification by email, SMS and in the portal, with a response deadline.
- Answer each request in the portal and attach documents where needed. Changes are only possible in the sections evaluators unlock.
- Resubmit before the deadline. A resubmitted idea returns to review, and your version history is kept.
- If you disagree with a decision, use the appeals procedure from the Help Center within the period stated in your decision notice.

9. Confidentiality and intellectual property

- You keep ownership of your idea. Submitting it does not transfer ownership to CEDA.
- Only assigned staff, evaluators, adjudicators and committee members who are bound by confidentiality can see your submission.
- Evaluator identities and individual scores are never shown to applicants.
- CEDA will not publish your idea without your permission.

10. Support and contacts

Live chat
09:00 to 16:00 (CAT), working days. Outside these hours, leave a message and we will reply within one working day.

Toll-free helpline
0800 600 253 (Mon to Fri, 07:30 to 16:30 CAT)
Email: enquiries@ceda.co.bw
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